

The National Sustainability Protection Policy

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? HMW Question

How might we make repairing and maintaining products feel rewarding for youth, rather than inconvenient?

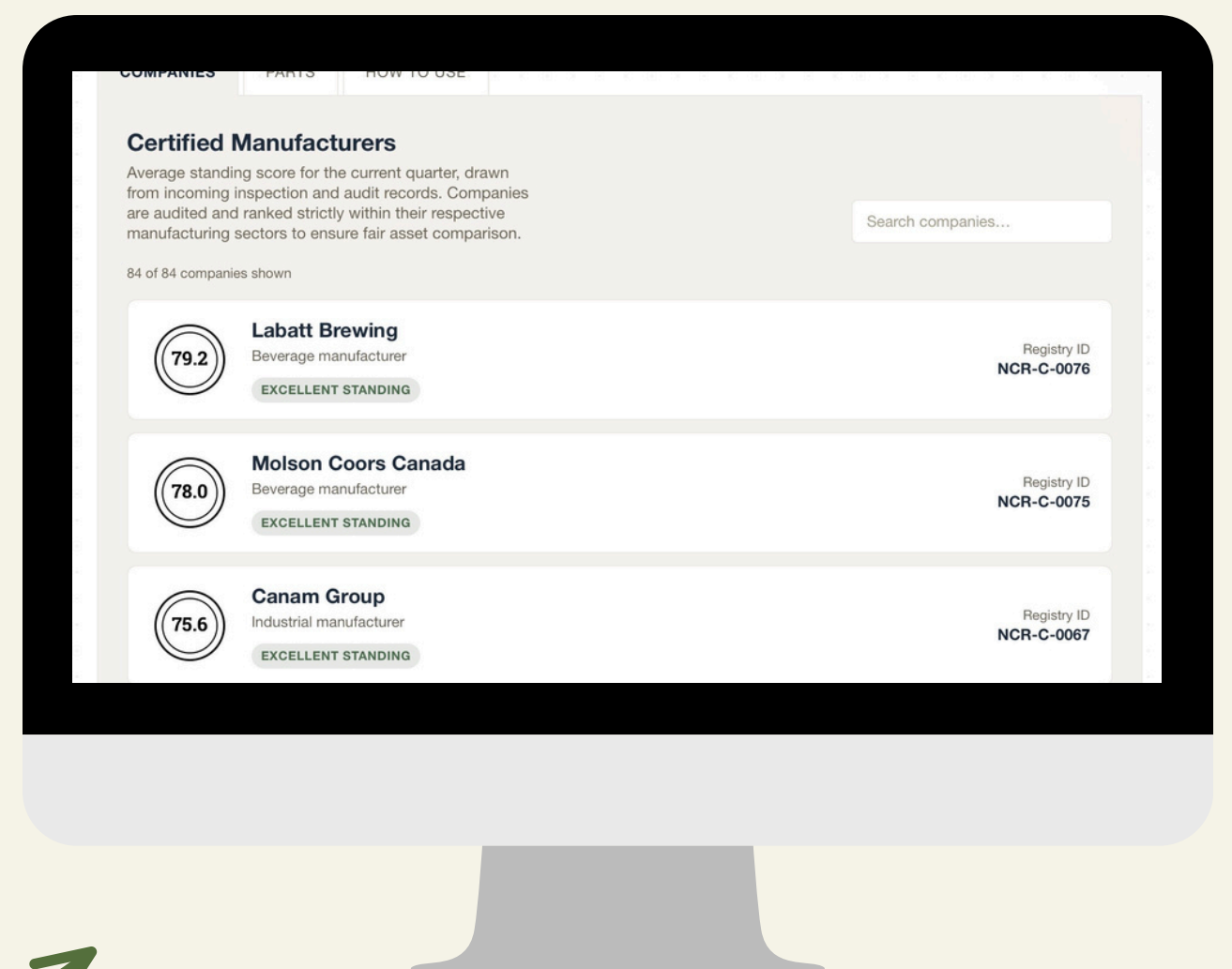
✓ Design Solution

A system that holds manufacturers accountable while giving youth an easy, affordable way to repair their products:

- *Component Registry & Recyclability Score:* Products display a mandatory QR code link to a standardized parts registry, repair instructions, and a Recyclability Score of the product.
- *Standardized & Accessible Repairs:* Products must be designed for easy disassembly using standard tools, and the parts that the product is made of should be available online or in local repair shops at an affordable price.
- *Tax Policy for Companies:* Companies must send their product designs to a governing body to log parts in a database. Products made with non-standard or hard-to-recycle parts get taxed higher per unit sold, pushing companies to design better products.

⚠ Problem

Repairing products is oftentimes very expensive and inconvenient because the products are designed with proprietary features such as custom screws, superglue, and non-standard parts, leading to an increase in frustration amongst youth. Youths find it almost impossible to fix something without having to pay higher fees and buy expensive specialized tools. This forces youth to give up entirely and replace the whole product, which fuels waste and keeps sustainable choices out of reach.



Potential Impact

Implementing this policy and design system creates direct positive impacts across environmental, economic, and behavioural aspects:

- *Reduction in Waste & Resource Depletion:* By compelling manufacturers to design products for easy disassembly using standard tools and eliminating barriers, fewer products will be prematurely discarded. This lessens overall waste and keeps sustainable, long-term product choices within reach for consumers.
- *Industry-Wide Shift Toward Sustainable Design:* The tax policy financially disincentivizes non-standard and hard-to-recycle parts by taxing non-complaintant products higher. This creates a strong economic incentive for companies to redesign products for modularity, standardization, and long term repairability.

